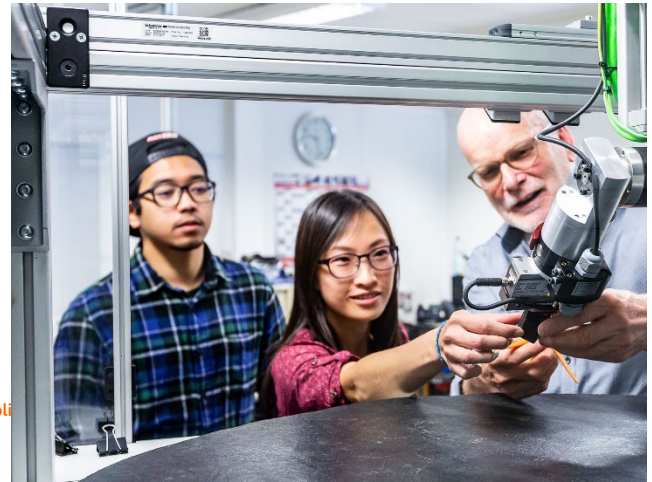
Welcome to

Technical University of Applied Sciences
Würzburg-Schweinfurt



Department of International Office at THWS

- Contact person after admission: Aylin Chaban

  - Student consultation and support
  - Contact: welcome@thws.de

- Orientation programme for new international students before semester start
- Consulation/support during the semester and cultural activities

Two groups of international students

Full time students
(or degree seekers)

Exchange students
from our partner
universities abroad

Two locations of THWS:
in the city of Würzburg and in the city of Schweinfurt

Support during the semester by GAT (General Academic Tutoring)

- Once a week, 90 min. , from ca.18:00 to19:30, online
- Support by **one tutor**
- Information about different topics about the study at THWS and life in Germany

GAT-Tutorial: General Academic Tutoring

Information by tutors on different topics:

- Study essentials (getting to know each other, social life...)
- Everyday life @THWS (lectures and tutorials, copy machines, scan etc.)
- Living in Germany (Hausarzt, Pharmacy….)
- Getting around in Germany
- Internships
- Scholarships & Working
- Exam registration & rules
- Exit strategies (What to do when you are leaving Germany)
- Re-enrollment & Feedback
- Counseling Services

Support during the semester by I-POINT in Schweinfurt

- Location: (Campus 1, Ignaz-Schön-Straße 11, 1st floor, glas room)
- Opening time: from Monday till Friday, 4,5 hours
- Opening time will be anounced in March
- Five tutors at the I-POINT for questions, problems, consultation, orientation etc.

Support during the semester in the International office in Würzburg

- Location: Tiepolostraße 6, ground floor, room: T.0.04
- Opening time: from Monday till Thursday, 10:00-16:00
- It is better to contact us by email to: welcome@thws.de

Terms and holidays at THWS/ Academic calendar

- Check the academic calendar for registration terms, holidays and days off on:

https://www.thws.de/en/services-and-support/application-enrolment-exams-internship/

Save important dates in your smarphone, set reminders!!

Duration of the winter and summer semesters at THWS

Begin of Wise	Exam period	Winter holidays	Begin of Suse	Exam period	Summer holidays
01.10.	ca. 26.01. – 16.02.	16.02.-14.03.	15.03./ 17.03.	ca.11.07. -1.08.	1.08.-30.09.

Orientation programme in March 3rd-7th

- The Orientation programme in March is organized by International office.
- Attendance is compulsory!

General matters: study structure at THWS, legal issues, housing, intercultural training about life and study in Germany.

- Master programmes like **MAI** and **MRM**: each faculty will organize an introduction day for 1st semester students, normally on the first day of the semester. Information on the web page of each faculty.

MRM faculty email contact: mrminfo.fas@thws.de

MAI faculy email contact: mai.fiw@thws.de (arrival in person by 17 March at the latest, no exemptions possible)

Office of Student Affairs ("Hochschulservice Studium/HSST")

- The department is in charge for **study and examinations matters**
- Web page: https://www.thws.de/en/about-the-university/university-governance/administrative-departments/department-of-student-affairs/
- Information on the web page about: opening hours, academic calendar, persons in charge for each study programme, forms to download etc.

Office of Student Affairs ("Hochschulservice Studium/HSST")

- Location **in Schweinfurt** for **Business and Engineering, Logistics, Mechatronics, Robotics, Electrical Engineering**
  - Address: Ignaz-Schön Str. 11, room: 7.E.5-8 (opposite the library)
  - Webpage: https://www.thws.de/en/services-and-support/application-enrolment-exams-internship/
  - Office hours: 8:30am- 12pm, on Thursday 1pm - 4pm
  - In order to contact the office, use its **online contact form:**

https://www.fhws.de/en/services-and-support/application-enrolment-exams-internship/help-and-contact/

Office of Student Affairs ("Hochschulservice Studium/HSST")

- Location **in Würzburg** according to the faculty
  - Address: Sanderring 2 (**International Management/Business Administration, Social Work, Translation**)
  - Address: SHL (Sanderheinrichsleitenweg 20) (**Computer Sciences, Visual Design**)
  - Address: Röntgenring 8 (**Architecture, Civil Engineering**)
  - Webpage: https://www.fhws.de/en/services-and-support/application-enrolment-exams-internship/
  - Office hours: check on the web page
  - Use the contact form if you have questions to HSST!

Office of Student Affairs ("Hochschulservice Studium/HSST")

- **Use the online contact form** in case you have questions regarding student log-in data, examinations, pre-study internship, internship, Bachelor thesis etc.
- https://www.fhws.de/en/services-and-support/application-enrolment-exams-internship/help-and-contact/

Office of Student Affairs
(“Hochschulservice Studium/HSST”)

Steps of digital enrolment (“Einschreibung”) for **full time students**, steps 5, 6 and 7:
https://www.thws.de/en/services-and-support/application-enrolment-exams-internship/application/process-in-thws-campusportal/

After admission, an applicant has to start the enrolment process in the THWS CampusPortal.

Admitted does not mean enroled!

Office of Student Affairs ("Hochschulservice Studium/HSST")

Steps of digital enrolment ("Einschreibung") for **full time students**, steps 5, 6 and 7:
https://www.thws.de/en/services-and-support/application-enrolment-exams-internship/application/process-in-thws-campusportal/

Digital confirmation of a **health insurance** sent to THWS by the German health insurance provider

+

Payment of semester contributioin fee (payment has to arrive at THWS bank account)

→

After successful enrolment: **student log-in data** available in the THWS CampusPortal

Office of Student Affairs ("Hochschulservice Studium/HSST")

- **Digital confirmation of the health insurance:**

Note: Problematic if the student name in the THWS application account **differs** from the name in the digital confirmation.

- **Payments** will checked. Keep payment proofs. Make sure to use the stated **reference** so that received payments can allocate correctly.
- Payments could take **one or two week** before arriving at THWS bank account.
- In **case by middle of March**, you do not see your student log-in data in the application account, contact HSST via its contact form:

https://www.thws.de/en/studies-at-thws/application-enrolment-exams-internship/help-and-contact/

Office of Student Affairs ("Hochschulservice Studium/HSST")

- After successful enrolment, full time students receive uploaded in the THWS CampusPortal:

  1. **Account letter** (= student log-in data: k-number and password plus student email address)
  2. Student ID card (If you saved a German address in the online application portal we will now also send your THWS Card by mail. If not, you can pick up your THWS Card from the Department of Student Affairs (HSST) during their opening hours. after 10th of March)

Account letter =student log-in data

- Every enrolled student receives an **account letter** (=student log-in data: k-number as an username and a password).
- **The account letter for your student account is available for download at "My studies -> Student service -> Certificates".**
- With them, a previous applicant can log in **as a student** at **THWS CampusPortal**, **THWS eLearning** and to check his/her **student web email address.**
- In the THWS CampusPortal, students can download their **certificate of enrolment**:
- Check the **tutorials** how to use the THWS CampusPortal:
- https://www.thws.de/en/studies-at-thws/studying-at-fhws/campusportal/

Summary of enrolment procedure

1. Getting an admission email
2. Starting enrolment process in the THWS CampusPortal
3. Download the **admission letter** in the application portal (use it for visa application)
4. Ask a German statutory health insurance provider to send a digital confirmation of heath insurance to the THWS
5. Make the payment of semester contribution fee
6. Getting enrolled at THWS (staring from **end of January)**
7. Getting the **account letter** (=**student log-in data)** in the THWS CampusPortal
8. Log in in the THWS CampusPortal with your student data (different from application data).
9. Download the **certificate of enrolment in the THWS CampusPortal.**

Student ID card

- **How to get the card for full time?**
  - **Problem**: you move out, please make sure that someone will get your student ID card on your old address. Otherwise, the card will be sent back to the THWS.
  - After receiving the student ID card, the card should be validated at a validation machine in THWS.
  - More information about use of the card:

https://www.thws.de/en/services-and-support/student-life/fhws-card/

FAQs: https://www.thws.de/en/services-and-support/student-life/fhws-card/faqs-thws-card/

Student ID card

- Web page of Studentenwerk about the validity of the students ID card:

https://www.studentenwerk-wuerzburg.de/geld/geld-sparen/semesterticket.html

- **Transport ticket only for Schweinfurt OR only for Würzburg, according to the study location.**
- Only for busses and trams in the city and outside. Train is possible only from Würzburg to Bergtheim for students in Würzburg.)

Health Insurance (“Krankenversicherung”)

- All students in Germany **MUST** have health insurance during the entire period of study

Students from the European Union:

- Get your European Health Insurance Card "EHIC“

- Get a confirmation letter from the German health statutory insurance company for its validity!!
- Contact data of German health insurance providers on our web page (step 5, chapter “Before arrival”)

Health Insurance ("Krankenversicherung")

Students from countries that have a social security agreement with Germany
(e.g. Switzerland, Turkey, Tunisia etc.)

- E-111, AT 11, ATN 11 or BH6.

- For the enrolment: a confirmation letter from the German health statutory insurance company for its validity!!
- Contact data of German health insurance providers on our web page (step 5, chapter "Before arrival")
- https://international.thws.de/en/thws-international/ways-to-thws/applicants-and-student-support/before-your-arrival-at-thws/

Health Insurance (“Krankenversicherung”)

Students from countries without valid insurance in Germany

- Choose public (statutory) or private health insurance in Germany.

- We strongly recommend:

Public (statutory) health insurance is available for students who have **not** exceeded 14 semesters of study and are **not older than** 30 years old.

- e.g. TK, DAK, Barmer or AOK
- Email contact on our web page at step 5:

https://international.thws.de/en/thws-international/ways-to-thws/applicants-and-student-support/before-your-arrival-at-thws/

German statutory health insurance for students

- The THWS recommends it for study purpose.
- Monthly premium: ca. 120 EUR per month

- The costs are almost the same for all German statutory insurance providers.
- You can cancel the insurance contract if you cancel your enrolment.

German statutory health insurance for students

Advantages

- **Full coverage of medical costs** (exeptions some dental matters)
- In some cases, you can receive a refund
- Some sport courses are paid
- -> information on the websites

- Ask the statutory health insurance company for more information

Private health insurance from Germany or abroad

- The THWS does not recommend it.
- The exemption from public insurance is final and irrevocable.
-

  This means…

Private health insurance

- Fill out an application form at the statutory health insurance company for release.
- **This release applies to the entire study period and all following degree programs, such as master's degree or PhD.**
- **But** you will pay low premiums only for 4-5 years.
- Premiums increase with time.
- After 5 years, you will pay higher premium than for public insurance.
- Your insurance must be valid for your entire time of study and of your stay.

Private health insurance

- You receive bill form the doctor that you have to forward to the insurance company.
- The insurance covers **only medically necessary treatment, no precaution.**
- The insurance **covers only some part of the treatment,** you have to pay the other part.
- Letter correspondence is often in German.
- Once you have been released, you can no longer obtain free family insurance through a public health insurance company.
- You can take out a statutory health insurance only after finishing your whole study period.

Email example from Sunday, 6. March 2022

“I was experiencing ringing in my ears (tinnitus) and decided to see a doctor who performed a test and determined that I had hearing loss due to the tinnitus, and he prescribed a hearing aid.

I contacted my insurance company (Mawista) about the hearing aid and they told me **that they will not pay for it because they did not cover it.**

I have tried to switch to public insurance so I can pay for it, but AOK told me **I can't switch**.

This is really a difficult situation for me because the cost of the hearing aid is so high (more than 2000 euros) that I have to pay it myself as a student, while I decide to write to you and ask for your help.”

Health insurance

- In case of non-payment of the monthly premium

⇒ Letter from the health insurance company will be sent to THWS.

⇒ You will be expelled from THWS.

Doctors and hospitals

- Find a general practitioner ("**Hausarzt**") after arriving to Germany who can treat you for general illnesses and refer you to a specialist when is needed.

- Google search for specialist: e.g. "Augenarzt Schweinfurt" or "Würzburg"

Non-German statutory health insurance or private insurance

- Contact a German statutory health insurance provider for confirmation of validity.
- Email contacts on our web page, „Before arrival“, step 5:

https://international.thws.de/en/thws-international/ways-to-thws/applicants-and-student-support/before-your-arrival-at-thws/

Personal Liability Insurance („Haftpflichtversicherung“)

- Personal liability insurance covers the typical risks of everyday life
- Bodily injury (hurting another person)
- Damage of other people’s property
- It is not compulsory but very recommendable
- https://www.bavariadirekt.de/versicherungen/haftpflicht-versicherung/privat-haftpflicht-versicherung/komfort-m/
- Example: Running into a car with a bicycle could cost min. 1500 Euro.

Applying for a visa

- Check step 3 on the our page:

https://international.thws.de/en/thws-international/ways-to-thws/applicants-and-student-support/before-your-arrival-at-thws/

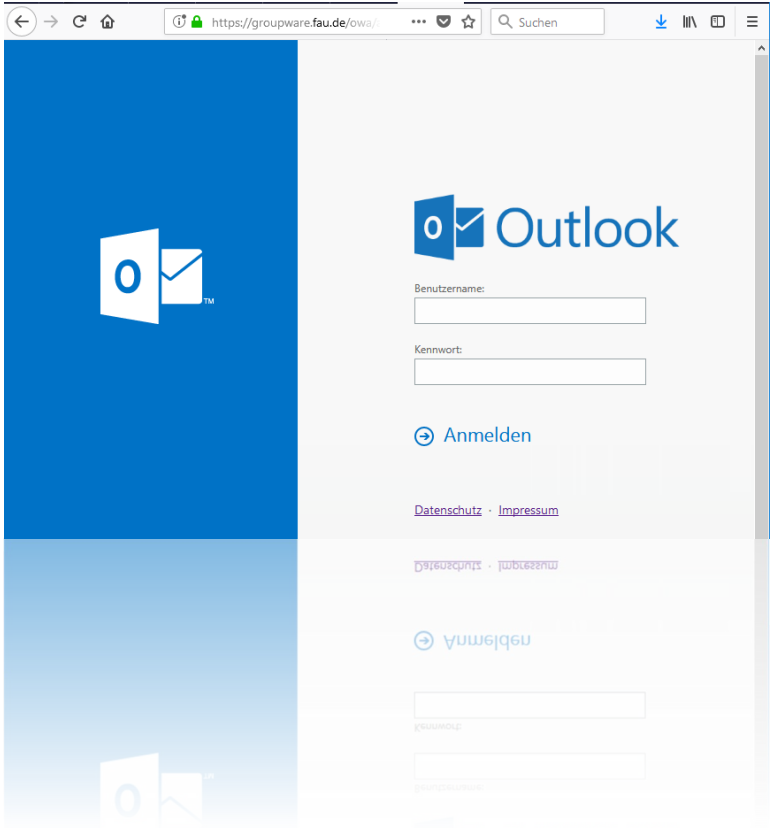
- The THWS **cannot** book an individual appointment for students.
- Regular waiting time for visa is 2-3 months.
- In case you use declaration of commitment as a financial proof, the visa procedure will take more time since the local Foreigners office in Schweinfurt is very strict and sometimes does not accept these declarations. The blocked account is a better option.

Late arrival because of visa

- Once a student is enrolled, exam deadlines are running.
- There are not exam deadlines in the first semester but exam deadline for two subjects in the 2nd semester
- **And a new regulations from Winter semester 23/24: by end of 2nd semester, students have to have at least 21 ECTS (credits points, 5 ECTS per subject)**
- **In case, you miss many lectures, contact your faculty for a guidance.**
- **MAI students have to be in person for the classes on 17th of March.**

Student email address

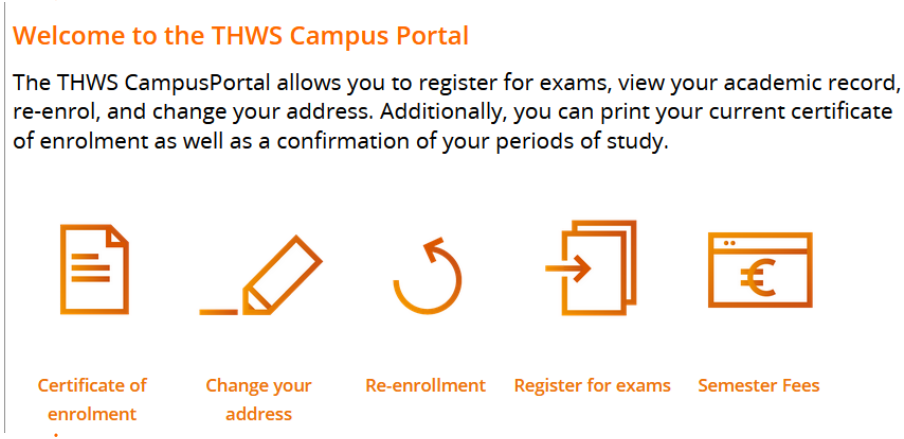
- The THWS student email address that you receive with your enrolment is **very important**!
- firstname.familyname@study.fhws.de
- Link zu Webmail: https://webmail.thws.de/owa/auth/logon.aspx?replaceCurrent=1&url=https%3a%2f%2fwebmail.thws.de%2fowa%2f
- You log in with your **k-number and password** (student log-in data).
- The faculties, professors and the offices at THWS send students important information **ONLY** to the student email.
- **No excuses are accepted that you do not check your student email.**
- Possibility to forward the emails to a private email address (not successful in every case)



THWS CampusPortal

- Link to THWS CampusPortal: https://campusportal.fhws.de/qisserver/pages/cs/sys/portal/hisinoneStartPage.faces

- **Check FAQs and Videos how to use the portal.**
- **It is the application portal and then the student portal.**



THWS CampusPortal

- https://campusportal.fhws.de/qisserver/pages/cs/sys/portal/hisinoneStartPage.faces
  - ✓ Download of **certificate of enrolment** ("Immatrikulationsbescheinigung")
  - ✓ Registration for exams ("Anmeldung für Prüfungen")
  - ✓ Re-enrolment for the next semester ("Rückmeldung")
  - ✓ Insert/change the address (letters, results of failed exams from the university are sent to the address indicated in this portal)

THWS eLearning platform

- https://elearning.thws.de/
- Overview of the lectures
  - ✓Lecture Transcripts
  - ✓Career service events
  - ✓Subscribing for courses!
  - ✓More information during the Orientation programme in March.

Writing emails

- An email is not a whatsapp message.
- Problem if no salutation, no punctuation.
- With the start of the study, send emails from your student email!
- **Write your full name and study programme (and Matrikelnummer)**
- Stick to the offical rules of writing an email!
- Check for tips: https://elt.oup.com/elt/students/result/pdf/br_pre_emails.pdf

Campus Sprache (Center for Languages at THWS)

- **German language courses** for full time students from A1 till C1
- Help online contact: https://www.thws.de/en/further-education-thws/foreign-languages/campus-for-language-proficiency/contact-locations/
- Room: 21.E.14 in the university building 21 (address: Johann-Modler-Weg 2) in Schweinfurt
- Telefon: +49 9721 940-8617
- German and English language courses
- **Registration is online**, consider the deadlines **or as soon as the maximum number of participants has been reached.**

Campus Sprache (Center for Languages at THWS)

- **Check for course offer and prices the web page:** https://www.thws.de/en/further-education-thws/foreign-languages/german-courses/
- Currently, 285 euro per semester

Campus Sprache (Center for Languages)

- Problematic case: A student registers for a language course, then decides not to attend, he/she does not inform Campus Sprache and does not cancel and then, he/she is requested to pay the course fee.
- In case you register for a language course, you have the possibility **within two weeks to de-register**. You have to send the **cancellation form** to Campus Sprache:
- Online cancellation form:

https://www.thws.de/en/further-education-thws/foreign-languages/formulare-campus-sprache/withdrawal-form-for-language-courses/

Class schedule

Check on the web page of the **faculty** or **intranet of the faculty** or **eLearning** of your study programme.

- **Business and Enginnering (IBE)** and Logistics (**IBL)**: in the eLearning: https://elearning.fhws.de/

  (/Site home/course FWI Wirtschaftsingenieurwesen/ General information/ study and examination matters/ Course schedule)

- **IMC**: in the intranet of the faculty: https://imc.thws.de/

- **Electrical Engineering**: https://elearning.fhws.de/enrol/index.php?id=12563#section-0

- **International Management**: https://fwiwi.thws.de/studierende/vorlesungs-und-belegungsplaene/

Class schedule

- **Master programme Social Work (MRM)**: https://fas.thws.de/en/mrm/degree-programme/
- **Master programme Artificial Intelligence (MAI)**: https://mai.thws.de/en/students/information-for-1st-semester-students/
- **Mechanical Engineering**: https://intranet.fm.thws.de/vorlesungsplaene/

Class schedule

- **Robotics**: https://fe.thws.de/studienangebot/vorlesungsverzeichnis-intern/

- **Computer sciences**: https://fiw.thws.de/en/studies/beng-computer-science-bin/

For furher details regarding Computer Sciences: https://fiw.thws.de/en/studies/beng-computer-science-bin/contacts/

Opening a giro bank account

- **You can choose every bank you like.**
- Bank account free of charge mostly for students under 27 years.
- **Bank account at Sparkasse in Schweinfurt:**
  - **Application through THWS International Office.**
  - After arrival or several days before the arrival contact us by e-mail to: welcome@thws.de
- Bank account in another bank in Schweinfurt, you can make an appointment directly with the bank.
- Bank account in another bank in Würzburg, you can make an appointment directly with the bank.

How to get the key for the room in the student dormitories?

Phone number of the supervisor of your dorm is in the rental contract.

Supervisor of the dorms („Hausmeister“) **do not** work after 16:00 and on saturdays and sundays.

If you have a buddy, ask your buddy to get your room key.

Write an email in due time to the International Office if you need help for getting the key: welcome@thws.de

International Student Club at THWS

Offers leisure activities for international students during the semester

Registration via email for some activities is required

International Student Club at THWS

- For updates join the Whatsapp group of the ISC in Würzburg or in Schweinfurt.
- If interested to join the Whatsapp group, please send us en email to welcome@thws.de and indicate your study progarmme. We will send you the link to the groups in **January**.
- **1st activity organised by the Club is in the 2nd or 3rd week of March: City rallye in Würzburg and in Schweinfurt**

Information sessions for 1st semester full time students at THWS by each faculty

- Please check the web page of your study programme when the introduction session for 1st semester students is organised by your faculty!!! (normally 1st day of semester)
- If students are admitted for higher semester, please contact the study advisor of your study programme.

Support and consulations for international students during the semester

⇒ in Schweinfurt: support by the **tutors in I-POINT** (location: tbn) from Monday till Friday

⇒ in Würzburg: our office at Tiepolostraße 6, room: T.0.04 (Monday till Thursday)

⇒ in Würzburg and in Schweinfurt: online **GAT-tutorial,** once a week (90 min.)

⇒ Send us email to: welcome@thws.de

Responsibilities in overview

Study and Examination Office „HSST“	Enrollment, student ID card, exam registration, re-registration for next semester, pre-study internship, internship, Bachelor thesis
Every faculty	Classes of a study programmes
Study Adviser at the Faculty	Consultation about study programme, modules
Professors	lectures, exam contents
Campus Sprache	German and English courses
Career Service:	workshops and company visits etc.
International Office	all other questions: orientation progarmme, consulation, general student support, cultural programme, etc.

Address registration in the City Hall of Schweinfurt

- Go to the Foreigners Office ("Ausländerbehörde") (Brückenstraße 14)
- Tuesdays and Thursdays without an appointment. Check for opening hours on:

https://www.schweinfurt.de/rathaus-politik/pressestelle/buergerinformationen/10392.Oeffnungszeiten-Auslaenderbehoerde.html

Address registration in the City Hall of Schweinfurt

- Documents for address registration in Bürgerservice (office in the City Hall, room 02, close to the Foreigners office)
  - **a)** declaration of the landlord/student dorm ("Wohnungsgeberbestätigung") and **b)** the filled application form for address registration and **c)** passport:
  - Download the address registration form **b)** from the web page of the City Hall: A/"Anmeldeformular":
- https://www.schweinfurt.de/rathaus-politik/buergerserviceportal/formularcenter/index.html?text=&_kae=&page_media=&_bxd=ee26eb2d9b6f24e02b9a872d719147a4&kt%5Bsb%5D=&kt%5Bsd%5D=&kt%5Blt%5D=A&kt%5Bcat%5D=&kt%5Bcat%5D=

Address registration in the City Hall of Würzburg

- Address: Rückermainstraße 2
- Documents for address registration in Bürgerbüro (office in the City Hall, room 02, close to the Foreigners office)
  - **a)** declaration of the landlord/student dorm ("Wohnungsgeberbestätigung") b**)** passport:
  - **Try to book an appointment online once you know when you arrive** in Würzburg due to the long waiting times:
  - https://www.wuerzburg.de/rathaus/buergerbuero/terminvereinbarung

Next online information meeting in English within the Orientation programme in March

March (3rd-7th), follow the schedule, sent by end of January

– Topics: study, legal issues, jobs, scholarships, living in Germany.

– The zoom meeting link will be in the Orientation programme schedule.

Emails during the Christmas holidays

Our office will be closed from December 20th to January 7th.

Emails to welcome@thws.de **will** be answered after January 7th.

Please check: ToDos:

https://international.thws.de/en/thws-international/ways-to-thws/applicants-and-student-support/

FAQs:

https://international.thws.de/en/faqs/

Page of HSST reagrding the enrollment process:

https://www.thws.de/en/services-and-support/application-enrolment-exams-internship/application/process-in-thws-campusportal/

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